Meal Planner App - PRD

Octoberfest Hackathon · working name: PlateWise (rename freely)

1. Problem

The food is already available, but one person standing in front of it often can't decide what to cook, so ingredients go unused.

2. Goal

Tell one person what they can cook right now from the ingredients they tick, in under 10 seconds, built in 50 minutes.

3. User

A single person (student or young professional) with a few ingredients on hand and no time to think.

4. The idea: "What can I cook?"

1. The user ticks the ingredients they have.
2. They tap Find meals.
3. The app shows meals they can make now, plus "almost" meals missing just one ingredient.

One screen, no login, no backend, no shopping list, no budget.

5. User stories (MVP)

1. As a user, I tick the ingredients I have from a checklist.
2. As a user, I see the meals I can cook right now.
3. As a user, I see meals that are missing only one ingredient, and which one.
4. As a user, I tap Surprise me and get one random meal I can make.

6. Extra ideas (only if time allows)

- Nigerian food mode: jollof rice, egusi soup, moi moi, beans and plantain, efo riro.
- Use it up: mark items about to spoil and meals using them show first.
- Mood filter: quick, filling, light or spicy.
- Today's plan: suggest breakfast, lunch and dinner for the day.
- Cook timer: simple steps with a countdown for the chosen meal.
- Remember ticks: save the checklist in localStorage.

7. Out of scope

Accounts, database, shopping lists, budgets, photo recognition, group or family mode, payments.

8. Requirements

- Checklist of about 25 common ingredients.
- About 15 hardcoded meals in a JavaScript array, each with a name and an ingredient list.
- Matching logic: a meal is ready when every ingredient is ticked, and almost ready when exactly one is missing.
- Meal cards showing name, ingredients and status (ready or missing one).
- Mobile-friendly layout.

9. Tech

One HTML file with plain JavaScript, or one React component. No backend, no database.

10. 50-minute plan

- 0-10 min: choose the 15 meals and 25 ingredients, write the data array.
- 10-30 min: build the checklist, matching logic and meal cards.
- 30-40 min: style for mobile, add Surprise me.
- 40-50 min: test, fix bugs, rehearse the demo.

11. Success

- Ticking ingredients and tapping Find meals shows correct results with no errors.
- Judges understand the app in under 30 seconds.

12. Risks

- Too many features: stick to the four MVP stories.
- Too much data entry: 15 meals is enough.
- Live demo problems: keep the file working offline.

13. Demo script (60 seconds)

1. Say the problem in one sentence.
2. Tick five ingredients.
3. Tap Find meals and show ready and almost-ready meals.
4. Tap Surprise me.
5. Name the next step: more meals and photo recognition of your food.